

BUSINESS INSIGHTS

Meta Ad Performance Analysis — Power BI

Findings and recommendations from 400,000 ad interactions across Facebook & Instagram



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Analysis period	7 May 2025 - 6 Aug 2025 (ad interactions)
Scope	50 campaigns · 200 ads · 9,841 users
Version	1.0 — 23 August 2026

Executive Summary

Across \$2.5M in total campaign budget, ads on Facebook and Instagram together drove **339,812 impressions**, **40,079 clicks** (11.8% CTR), and **2,031 purchases**. Facebook outperforms Instagram on both raw volume and conversion efficiency, Stories is the strongest ad format, and — most importantly for planning — **campaign budget size has almost no relationship with conversion rate**. The best-converting campaign in the dataset spent 84% less than the worst-converting one and still converted 3.4x better.

339,812

IMPRESSIONS

40,079

CLICKS

2,031

PURCHASES

11.79%

CTR

5.07%

CONV. RATE

\$2.5M

TOTAL BUDGET

1. Facebook vs. Instagram

Facebook carries roughly 64% of total impressions (215,972 vs. 123,840) and edges out Instagram on every conversion metric, despite Instagram posting a marginally higher raw CTR.

Facebook

Impressions	215,972
Clicks	25,389
Purchases	1,323
CTR	11.76%
Conversion Rate (purch/click)	5.21%
Purchase Rate (purch/impr)	0.61%

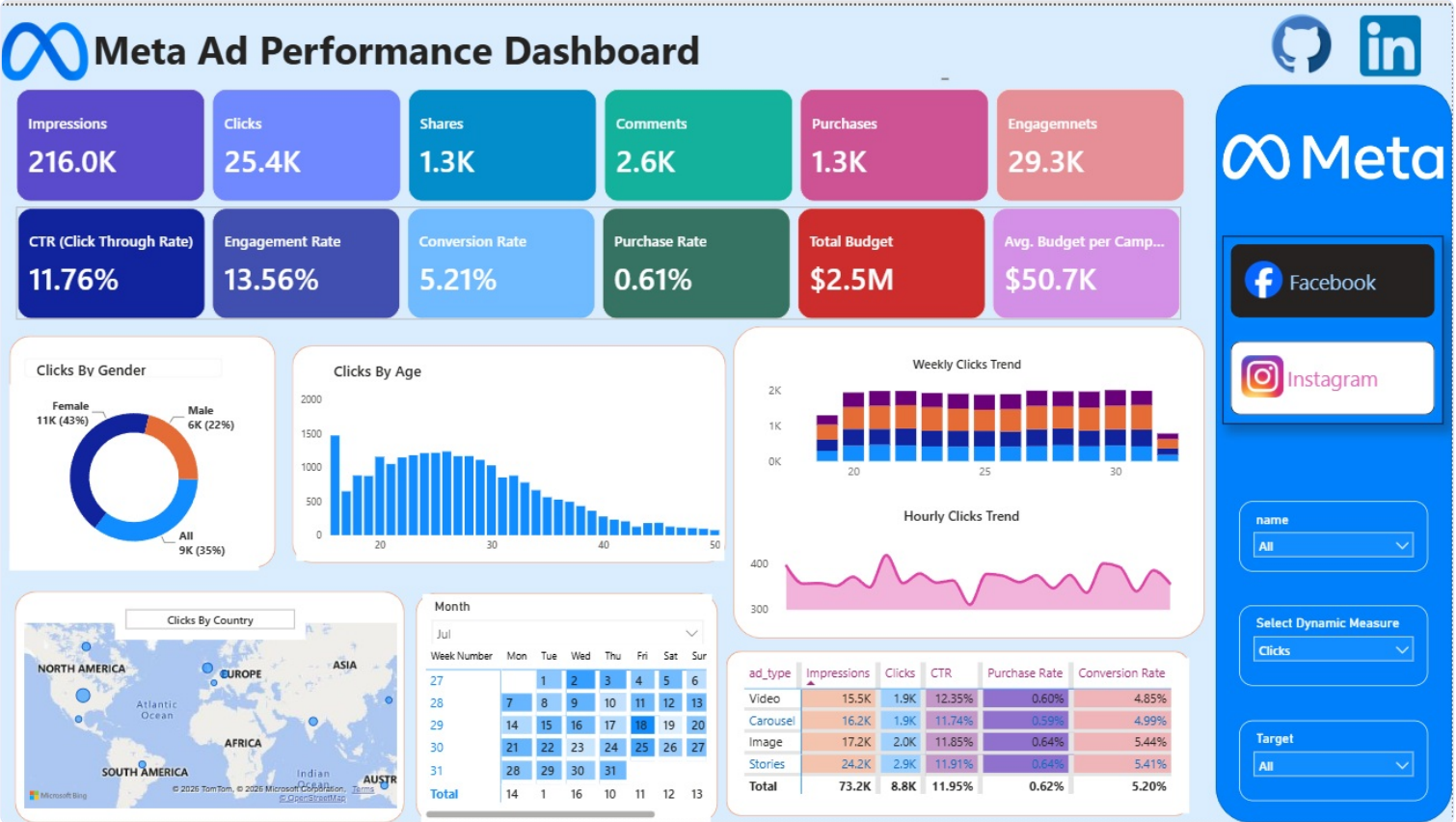
Instagram

Impressions	123,840
Clicks	14,690
Purchases	708
CTR	11.86%
Conversion Rate (purch/click)	4.82%
Purchase Rate (purch/impr)	0.57%

FINDING 1

Instagram's higher CTR doesn't carry through to purchases.

Instagram edges Facebook on CTR (11.86% vs 11.76%) — people are slightly more likely to click an Instagram ad. But Facebook converts those clicks into purchases at a meaningfully higher rate (5.21% vs 4.82%), an 8% relative gap. Instagram traffic is clicking more out of curiosity or scroll momentum; Facebook traffic that clicks is more purchase-intent.



Meta Ad Performance Dashboard



name

All

Select Dynamic Measure

Comments

Target

All

Dashboard — Instagram view (Comments measure)

2. Ad Format Performance

Ad Type	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Conv. Rate	Purchase Rate
Stories	108,932	12,782	11.73%	5.34%	0.63%
Video	56,043	6,667	11.90%	5.07%	0.60%
Carousel	86,673	10,155	11.72%	5.13%	0.60%
Image	88,164	10,475	11.88%	4.67%	0.55%

FINDING 2

Stories is the strongest all-round format; Image is the weakest converter.

Stories leads on both share of volume (108,932 impressions — nearly double any other format) and on conversion rate (5.34%). Image ads pull a respectable CTR (11.88%, second-best) but convert worst (4.67%) — they get looked at and clicked, but that traffic buys the least. Video has the fewest impressions of any format (56,043, roughly half of Stories) yet posts the top CTR (11.90%), suggesting it's under-served relative to its click-worthiness.

FINDING 3

Instagram is barely using Video.

Instagram Video ads account for just 10,273 impressions — less than a third of any other Instagram format, and far below Facebook Video's 45,770. Given Video posts the best CTR of any format overall, this looks like an under-investment on Instagram specifically rather than Video underperforming.

3. Audience & Targeting

FINDING 4

Female-targeted ads drive the most clicks, but the real audience skews younger than targeting brackets assume. Of Facebook clicks, 43.3% come from ads targeted at Female, 34.9% at All, and 21.7% at Male — Female targeting is punching above its weight. Separately, looking at the actual age of users who click (not the ad's target bracket), the median clicking user is **27 years old** (middle 50% of clickers are 21–32). Two of the four ad targeting brackets (35–44 and "All") sit above where most of the real engaged audience actually is.

Top markets by click volume

Country	Clicks	Country	Clicks
United States	11,556	Australia	2,749
United Kingdom	5,700	Brazil	2,268
Canada	3,805	Mexico	1,903
India	3,641	Japan	1,872
Germany	3,166	France	1,431

The US alone accounts for just over a quarter of all clicks (11,556 of 40,079); the top 3 English-speaking markets (US, UK, Canada) together account for over half.

4. Budget Efficiency

FINDING 5

Bigger budgets do not buy better conversion rates.

Across the 50 campaigns, the correlation between total budget and conversion rate is effectively zero ($r = -0.09$) — if anything, slightly negative. The correlation between budget and raw click volume is also weak ($r = 0.13$). Budget size is a poor predictor of campaign quality in this dataset; creative, targeting, and format choices matter far more than spend.

Campaign	Budget	Clicks	Purchases	Conv. Rate	Cost / Purchase
Best converting					
Campaign_27_Q3	\$12,986	393	33	8.40%	\$394
Campaign_31_Summer	\$72,208	589	42	7.13%	\$1,719
Campaign_23_Winter	\$26,002	605	42	6.94%	\$619
Worst converting					
Campaign_36_Q3	\$58,802	409	10	2.44%	\$5,880
Campaign_19_Winter	\$33,182	419	14	3.34%	\$2,370
Campaign_32_Summer	\$81,745	801	27	3.37%	\$3,028

Campaign_27_Q3 spent 84% less than Campaign_32_Summer (which spent 82% more than average) yet converted 2.5x better and cost 87% less per purchase (\$394 vs. \$3,028). Median cost-per-purchase across all 50 campaigns is \$1,153 — Campaign_36_Q3 runs at over 5x that.

5. Timing Patterns

FINDING 6

No meaningful day-of-week or time-of-day effect in this dataset.

Event volume is essentially flat across all seven days (57,403 on the highest day, Friday, vs. 56,990 on the lowest, Sunday — a spread of under 1%) and across all four day-parts (Morning/Afternoon/Evening/Night each land within 0.2% of a 25% share). There's no scheduling signal to act on here — spend timing decisions should be driven by other factors (audience availability, competing spend, creative fatigue) rather than by this data.

6. Recommendations

1. Shift incremental budget toward Stories, and increase Instagram Video investment.

Stories already leads on conversion rate and volume — treat it as the default format for new campaigns. Separately, Video's top-of-class CTR (11.90%) combined with Instagram's near-absence of Video inventory (10,273 impressions) points to a specific, low-risk test: run more Video creative on Instagram before assuming the format underperforms there.

2. Audit large-budget campaigns individually rather than assuming spend correlates with results.

With budget explaining almost none of the variance in conversion rate ($r = -0.09$), campaigns like Campaign_36_Q3 and Campaign_32_Summer (both bottom-3 on conversion despite above-average budgets) should be reviewed for creative/targeting fit before their next flight, rather than renewed on the strength of their spend alone.

3. Re-check the age targeting brackets against actual clicking behavior.

With a median clicking age of 27 and the middle 50% between 21-32, campaigns targeting 35-44 or "All" age groups are likely

reaching past their most responsive audience. Narrowing toward 18-34 on underperforming campaigns is a low-cost test.

4. Fix the user_id data quality issue before the next data refresh.

455 of 9,950 distinct users active in the event log (4.6%) can't currently be matched to a demographic profile because of an Excel formatting bug on the source file (see [Project_Documentation.pdf](#), Section 3.1). Correcting this before the next load will make every demographic cut in this report slightly more complete.